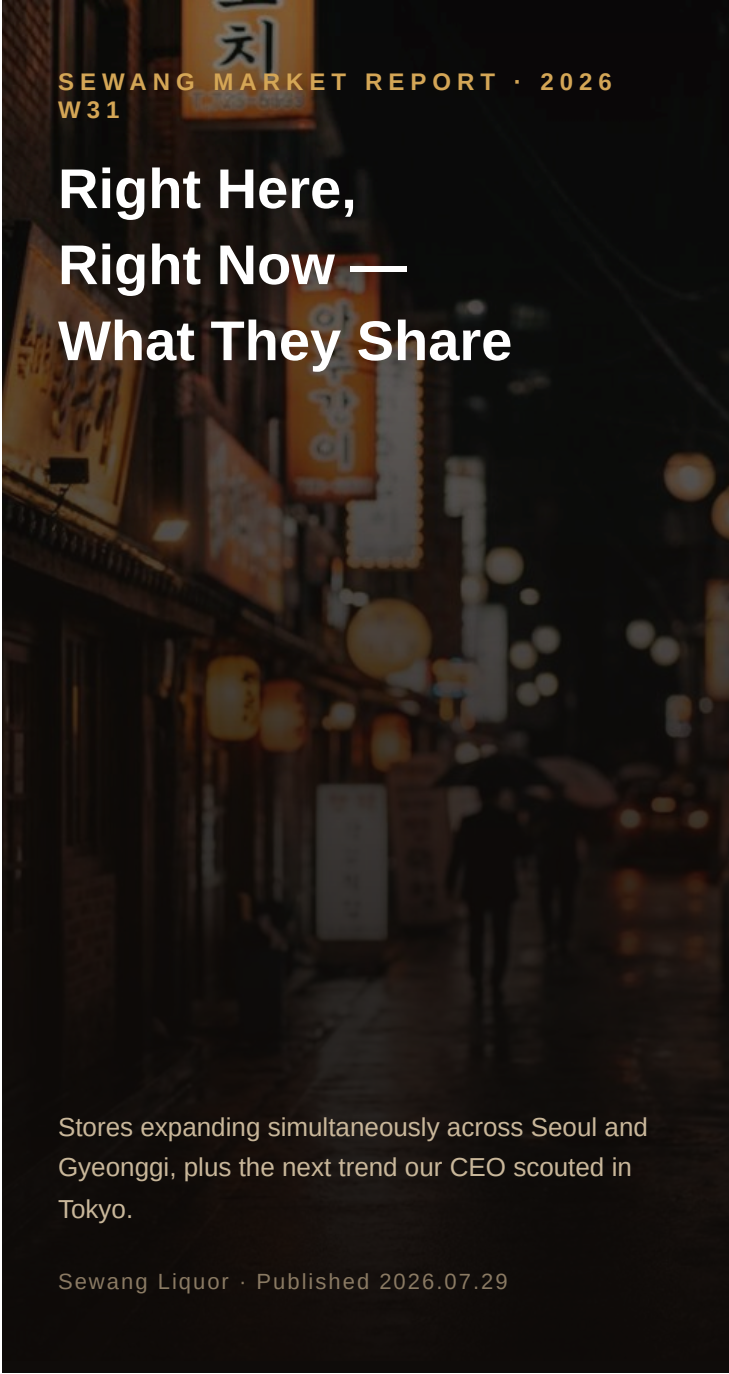


A blurred night street scene in Seoul, likely a traditional market area. The image shows a narrow street lined with buildings. Numerous traditional Korean lanterns (dongguk) are hanging from the buildings, casting a warm, yellow glow. Several signs with Korean characters are visible, including one with the character '치' (chi) at the top. The background is dark, with some distant lights and a few figures walking, creating a sense of depth and atmosphere.

SEWANG MARKET REPORT · 2026
W31

Right Here, Right Now — What They Share

Stores expanding simultaneously across Seoul and Gyeonggi, plus the next trend our CEO scouted in Tokyo.

Sewang Liquor · Published 2026.07.29

How to Read This Issue

- Saengmacha, Zanzan, Wooirak, Pocha Jungmun — familiar names are opening new stores simultaneously across Seoul and Gyeonggi.
- Torikizoku followed its Hongdae store with a new Euljiro-3-ga location, accelerating Japanese-style yakitori chains' downtown push.
- Honsulbar chain Yahwa completed its franchise disclosure filing and confirmed its 95th store contract, with new openings like Baegot continuing.
- On a trip to Shinjuku, Ueno, and Asakusa, our CEO identified three benchmarking ideas that can be applied here.

4+

franchise
brands
expanding at
once

3

key stores
from Tokyo
scouting

95

confirmed store
contracts
for Yahwa
honsulbar

This Week's Instagram Buzz

We gathered stores that recently opened or are trending. From brand-new openings to Sewang's own accounts — the pattern behind what's hot right now looks the same.



Yakitori Zanzan Icheon

A new yakitori specialist in the Icheon area. Local buzz has been strong since day one.



Saengmacha Geoyeo · Zanzan Munjeong

Two different franchises opened side by side in the Geoyeo/Munjeong area — a clear sign of simultaneous expansion within the same district.



Wareureu Mansion

Suwon Station, Guwol, Suwon Yeongtong, Sanbon, Incheon Yeonsu, Bangi — this brand has opened stores across the metro area in just the past few months, with several locations gaining traction right out of the gate.

Why You See Them Everywhere

Four brands that have visibly grown their store count across Seoul and Gyeonggi in recent months.

Saengmacha

Izakaya · nationwide expansion

Most locations

Zanzan

Yakitori & izakaya · highest density per area

Accelerating

Wooirak

Izakaya · Seoul metro focus

Many new stores

Pocha Jungmun

Pocha-style · new entrant

Early stage

"When the same brand takes off in multiple districts at once, it's a signal that the format itself is what the market wants right now."

Not Just Yahwa — A Three-Way Race

A follow-up to our June deep-dive on the honsulbar (solo-drinking bar) market. Beyond Yahwa, several other brands are expanding in the same category.

95

Yahwa
confirmed
stores
(after disclosure
filing)

49%

7-day
return visit rate

53%

30-day return
rate
· #1 in category

Yahwa — New Baegot Location

With its disclosure filing complete and franchise contracts expanding, new stores like the Baegot location keep opening. With return-visit data now backing the brand, franchise inquiries keep climbing too.

Jeju Gyeot Seoul Honsulbar

The second honsulbar brand, growing simultaneously across Gunja, Hapjeong, Nowon, Yongridan-gil, Seongnam Jeongja, Sangbong, Konkuk, and Suwon Yeongtong — expanding the category alongside Yahwa.

Hertz Honsulbar

A third honsulbar brand that just entered the market in Uijeongbu. Still early, but a sign that new brands keep entering this category.

Torikizoku: From Hongdae to Euljiro



Torikizoku Euljiro-3-ga

One of Japan's three major yakitori chains, Torikizoku, just opened in Euljiro-3-ga. Its fourth Seoul location, following its Hongdae flagship, Yeonnam, and Hongik Univ. Station branches, shows the low-price, high-turnover yakitori format continuing to expand.



Pairing the still-thriving after-work drinking culture of Euljiro with affordable Japanese-style yakitori — the site selection clearly targets second-round demand.

SPECIAL FEATURE

Tokyo Benchmarking Trip: 3 Days, 2 Nights

2026.07.22–24 · Shinjuku · Ueno · Asakusa

Three stores our CEO visited in person, with
takeaways for the Korean market.

Nakizakana: Customers Pick Their Own Fish



The Okamochi Concept

Customers pick their fish from a basket of whole fish, then have it prepared on the spot as sashimi, grilled, fried, or simmered. The core appeal: the fun of choosing, paired with visible freshness.

Even a partial version of this "pick it yourself" theater could raise both spend per guest and dwell time at Korean izakayas.

Toromasa: The Secret to Always Being Full



Why It's Always Packed

Turnover management, a well-run waitlist, and the simplicity of betting on one signature dish were confirmed as the keys to staying full. Trimming the menu and speeding up cooking is directly applicable to small stores here.

GLITCH Coffee: How a Small Shop Wins



A Specialty Roaster in Jimbocho

A narrow storefront coffee shop tucked into the bookstore-lined streets of Jimbocho. A tight space and a bold logo double as its interior design, while retail bean sales add a second revenue stream alongside cafe sales.

3 Lessons for Liquor Retailers

① Sell the origin story (like a "Nagano sake, Shigaraki highball" narrative) ② Use small comparison sets to drive repeat purchases ③ Publish your cost to build price trust — it's a coffee shop, but the insight applies directly to liquor retail too.

We'll Keep Growing as Your Partner

From Saengmacha to Torikizoku, and the next trend confirmed in Tokyo — Sewang Liquor prepares for what comes next, together with our partners.

Sewang Liquor Co., Ltd.

Founded in 1978, we've supplied liquor to Seoul and Gyeonggi's hospitality and dining channels for nearly 50 years as a full-line wholesale distributor. From hotels to neighborhood izakayas, we grow together with both new and existing partners through one-stop, multi-category supply and channel-specific service.

- One-stop, multi-category supply · channel-specific order handling
- Dedicated account managers · one-on-one consultation
- Draft beer quality control · cold-chain delivery system

Your Sales Contacts

이한우 EVP
010-5210-5449
Hotels & Fine Dining

임창수 Managing Director
010-3742-3054
Gangnam·Yeoksam·Nonhyeon·Sinsa

박정언 Managing Director
010-3286-9489
Sales HQ · Report Publishing

손승일 Director
010-7539-3535
Yongsan·Hannam·Itaewon / Franchise

이원철 GM
010-3354-2101
Gangbuk·Jongno·Jung-gu

채현용 GM
010-8889-3057
Seongdong·Seongsu·Wangsimni / Wine & Whisky

김환 GM
010-4789-3282
Mapo·Seodaemun·Yeonnam·Hongdae

오건훈 GM
010-3495-6515
Songpa·Gangdong·Jamsil / Japanese liquor

신흥철 GM
010-9259-6474
Gwanggyo·Suwon·Bundang·Pangyo

배종환 Manager
010-9209-6526
Gangseo·Magok·Balsan·Yeouido

유광석 Manager
010-4565-6039
Hanam·Misa·Guri·Namyangju

성현우 Manager
010-3375-3646
Yeongdeungpo·Guro·Yangcheon·Dongjak

황현웅 Asst. Manager
010-9123-4341
New Account Development